



BLENDING OF SPORTS ENTERTAINMENT AND POLITICAL MESSAGING

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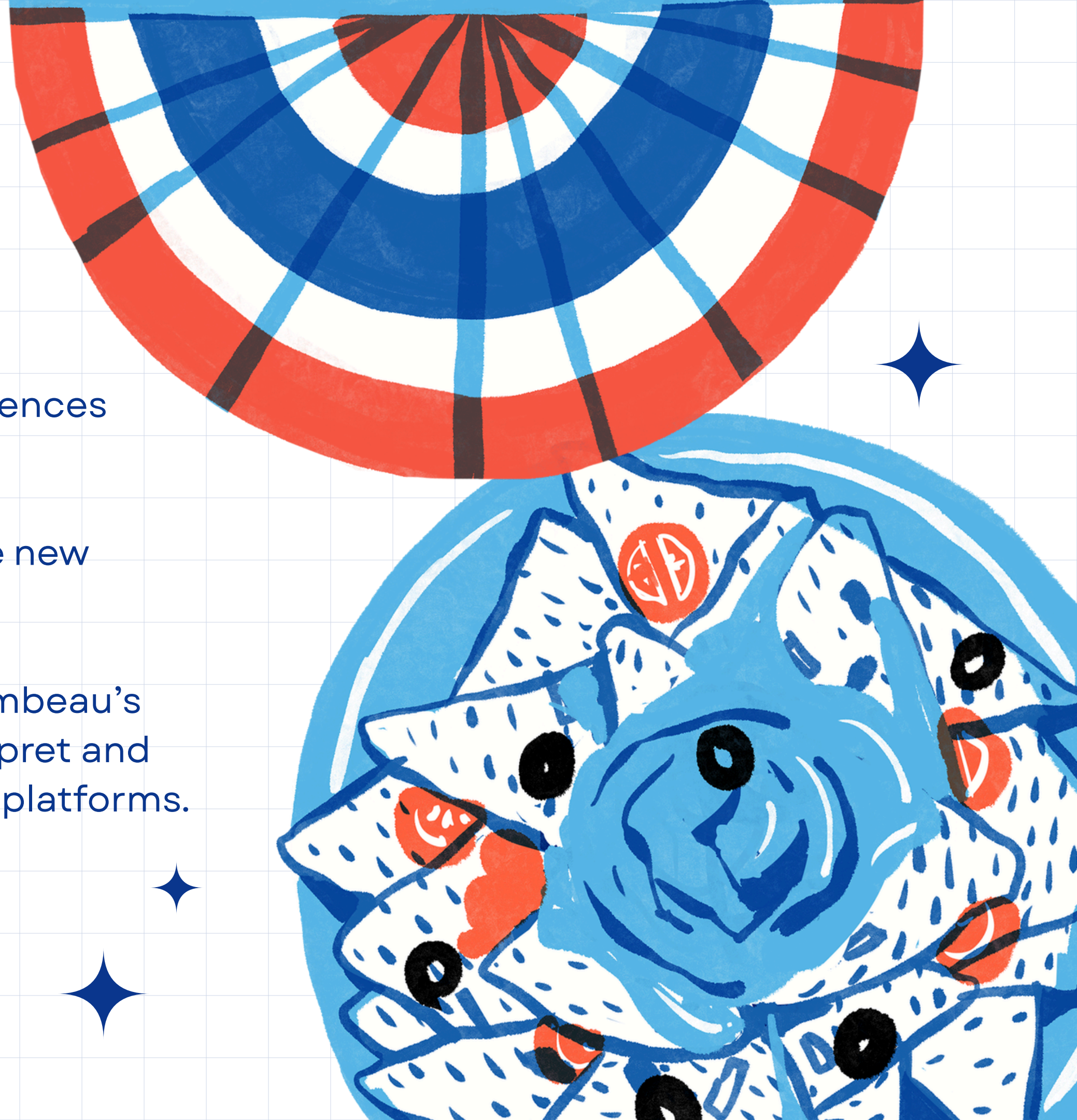


Social Issue Framing & Context

The rise of social media has changed how audiences respond to sports content.

Moments that blend sports and politics create new spaces for public reaction.

Donald Trump's appearance on Bryson DeChambeau's Break 50 series highlights how audiences interpret and debate this overlap through comments across platforms.



Research Question



How do audiences across YouTube, X, and Instagram negotiate and react to the blending of sports entertainment and political messaging in the context of Donald Trump's appearance on Bryson DeChambeau's "Break 50" series?



Why is this important?



- Audience reactions shape how sports, media, and politics intersect
- Influences athlete reputation, fan perception, and media narratives
- Blended content can increase engagement, but also polarization
- Helps organizations understand risks and opportunities of political content





Data & Scope

We utilized B50 comment datasets to capture audience reactions to sports-political content and how discourse is shaped across platforms

B50 COMMENT DATASETS

58,464 total comments

YouTube

45,623 comments

Audience reactions and discussion

Reflects how users interpret sports-political content

Includes support, criticism, and neutral responses

Instagram

11,833 comments

Direct audience interaction

More sports-focused and reactive engagement

Includes shorter, less political responses

X (Twitter)

1,008 comments

Real-time public discourse

More opinion-driven and political expression

Reflects immediate reactions and debate

Each comment coded for:

- stance (pro, anti, neutral/non-political)
- frame (sports, politics, blended)
- normalized engagement

Analytical Strategies

Mixed Coding Approach: combined dictionary based detection with context sensitive rules to classify political stance and interpretive frame

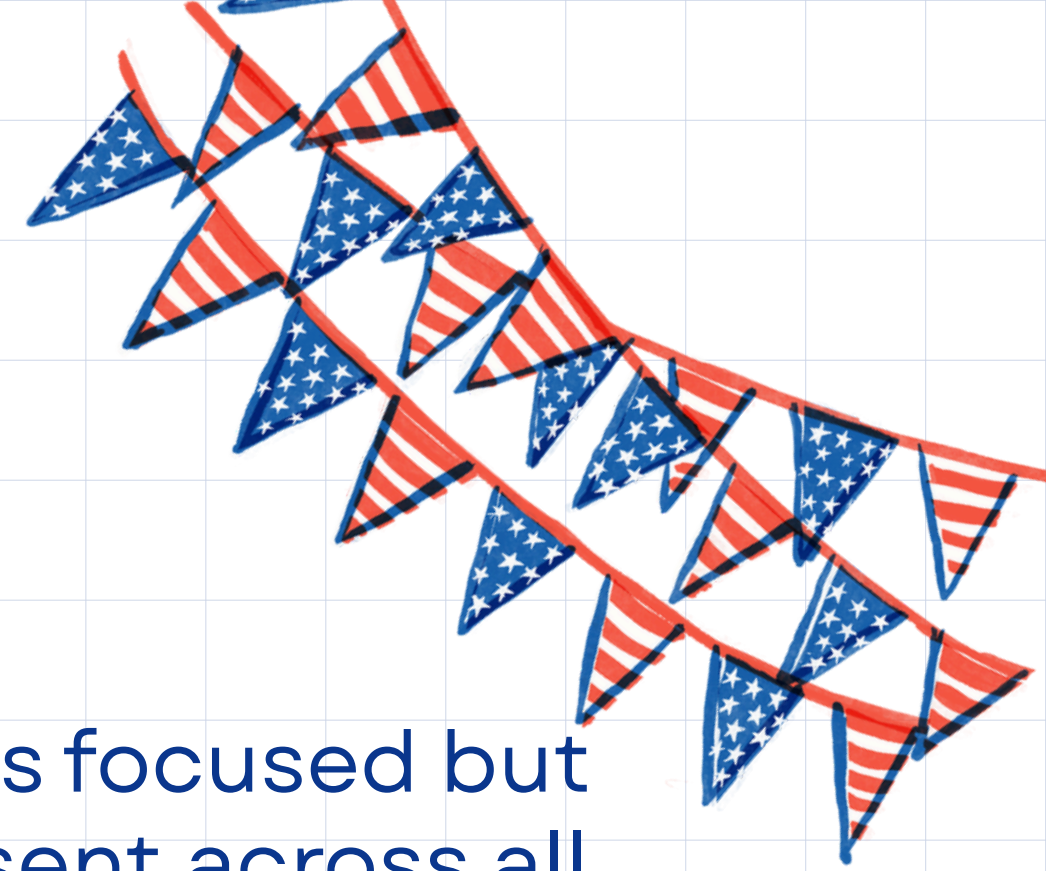
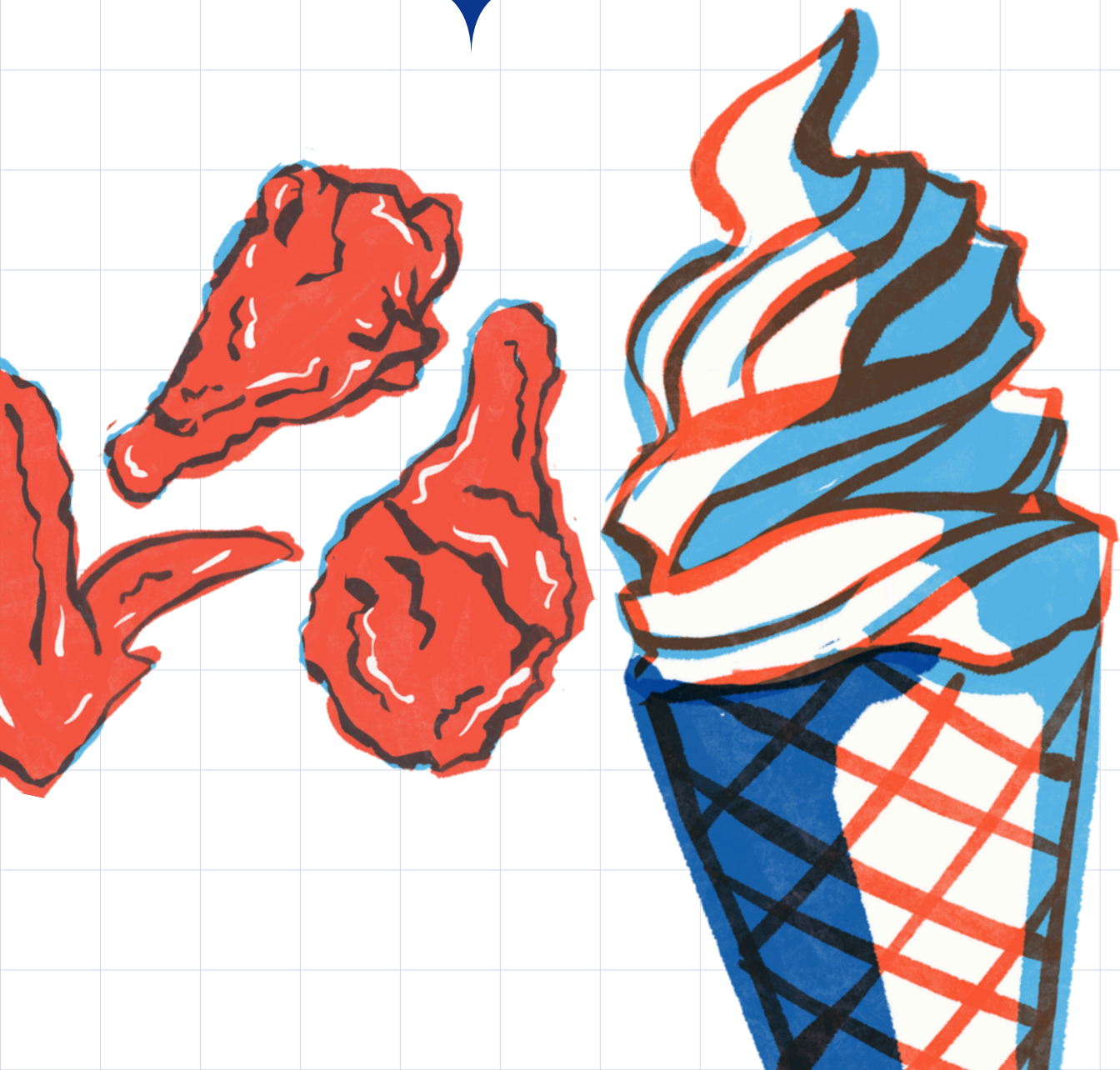
Association Testing: used chi-square to evaluate whether stance and framing patterns differ by platform and frame choice

Interpretive Layer: quantitative outputs with qualitative theme analysis to explain how audiences negotiate sport-politics blending

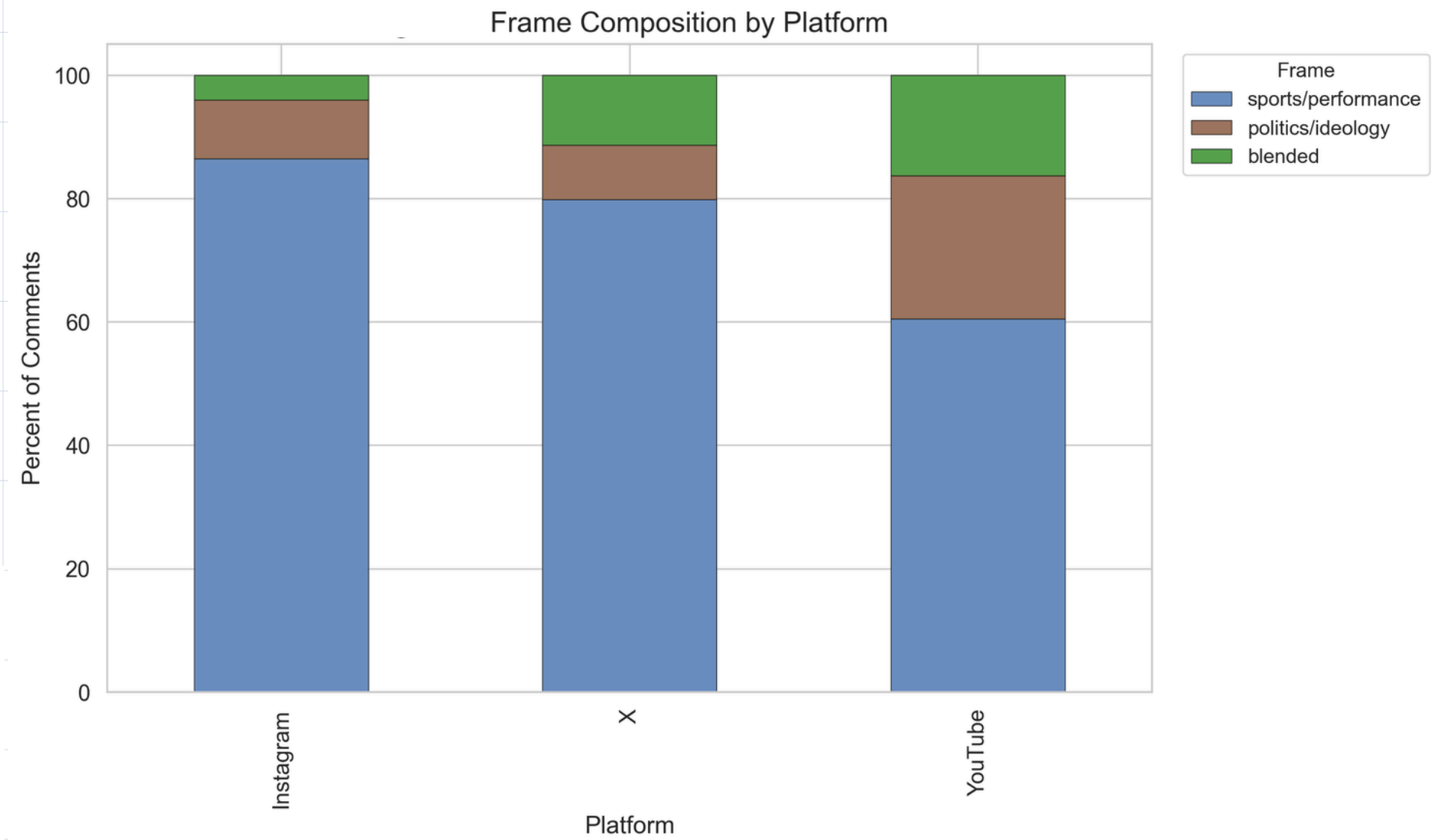
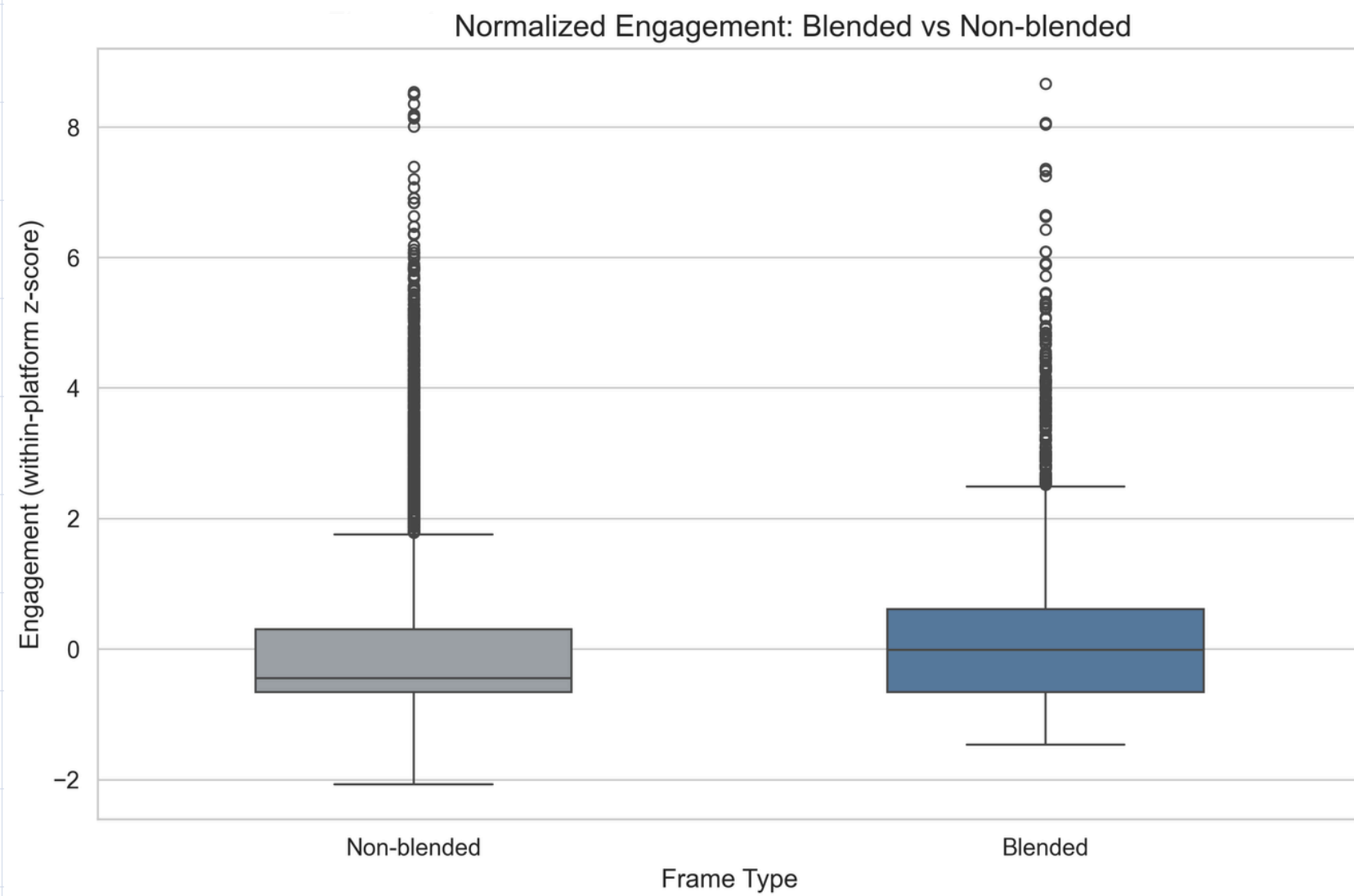


Key Findings

- Most comments stayed sports focused but politics were consistently present across all platforms
- Stance and frame were strongly linked
 - explicit pro/anti comments were clustered in political or blended while neutral were mainly sports framed
- Blended comments drew higher engagements
 - small but reliable effect in the data
- The strongest pattern is when the stance in comments becomes explicit

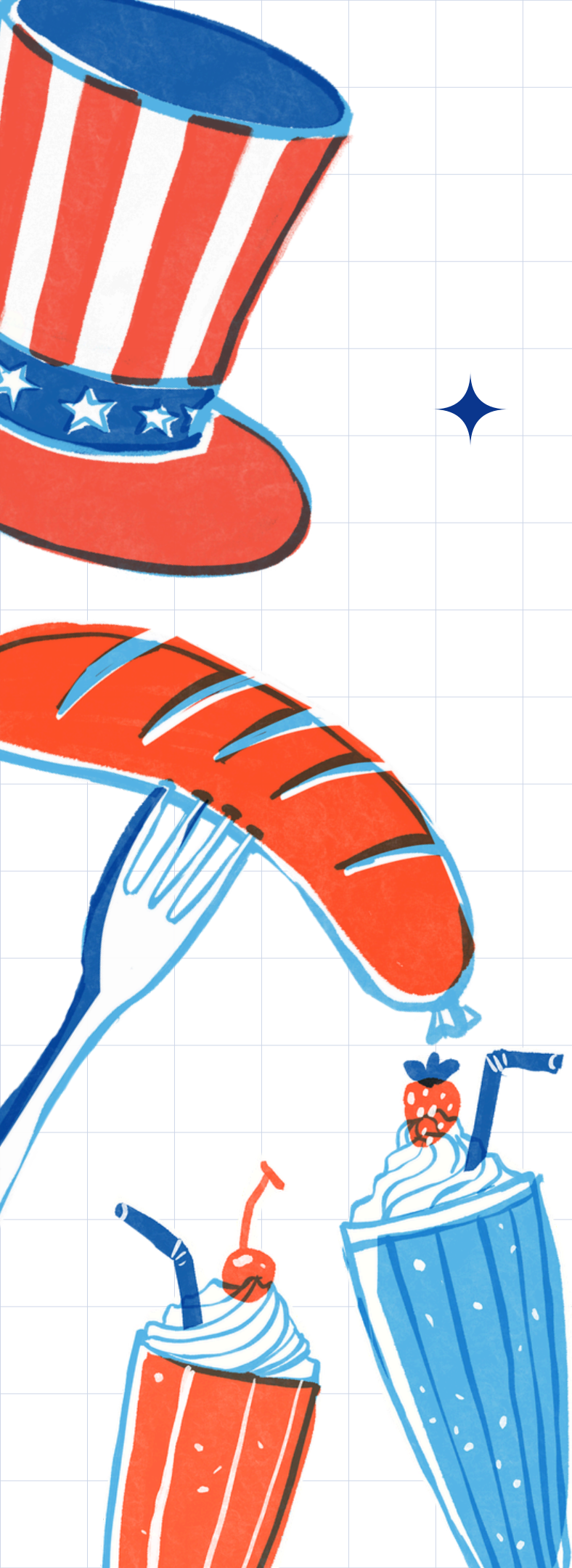


Figures



Interpretation

- Sports still dominates but politics are becoming increasingly involved
- Content Platform matters the most for meaning
 - Instagram was the most depoliticized while Youtube and X had the most mixed framing
- Stance and frame are closely linked - pro and anti Trump comments were focused on politics while neutral were concentrated in sport
- Political comments are amplified over neutral/sport framing
- Audiences are not just reacting to golf, they are actively looking at political content



Implications

- Political crossover can boost engagement but also creates potential for polarization and backlash
- Blending framing may be able to help with visibility for sport content
- Audiences co-produce meaning => they do not just passively consume content
- Strategies for media reach should be tailored based on platform
- Social language heavily influences how items are interpreted across audiences



Thank you!
Questions?

